DHA-Rec: Dual-Horizon Attentive Recommendation Network for Sequential Item Prediction

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Under Double-Blind Peer Review for Leading AI Information Retrieval Conference

ABSTRACT— Sequential recommendation aims to forecast users' next preferred items based on their historical interaction trajectories. Prevailing self-attentive sequential models often process historical interactions as a uniform monolithic sequence, inevitably entangling transient session-level fluctuations with persistent long-term behavioral preferences. In this work, we propose **DHA-Rec** (*Dual-Horizon Attentive Recommendation Network*), a novel sequential recommender that explicitly disentangles short-term dynamic intent from long-term preference horizons. Specifically, DHA-Rec processes local windowed interactions with a focused short-term attention block while concurrently tracking global historical contexts with a long-term attentive backbone. An adaptive cross-horizon gating mechanism dynamically synthesizes these dual representations to generate personalized item recommendations. Extensive empirical benchmarks on three public datasets (MovieLens-1M, Amazon-Beauty, and Steam) demonstrate that DHA-Rec consistently outperforms competitive sequential baselines including SASRec and GRU4Rec across multiple evaluation metrics (HR@5, NDCG@5, HR@10, NDCG@10, MRR@10).

1. INTRODUCTION

Modern digital platforms rely heavily on sequential recommender systems to deliver timely and personalized item suggestions. A user's sequence of clicks, purchases, or ratings reflects a complex blend of both longstanding domain interests and fleeting micro-intentions.

While attention-based sequential recommendation architectures (e.g., SASRec) have achieved significant popularity, they fundamentally map the entire interaction history through unified self-attention layers. This uniform treatment risks diluting immediate micro-intentions within extensive historical backgrounds, or conversely, allowing transient noise to obscure core user identities. To overcome these limitations, this paper develops a dual-horizon framework capable of cleanly decoupling and adaptively fusing distinct temporal horizons.

2. CONTRIBUTIONS

The primary contributions of this paper are threefold:

1. **Dual-Horizon Representation Disentanglement:** We propose a decoupled architectural formulation separating volatile short-term session dynamics from persistent long-term user preferences, overcoming representation interference in monolithic sequence models.
2. **Attentive Cross-Horizon Gating:** We devise an adaptive cross-horizon fusion mechanism that dynamically weighs the predictive relevance of recent actions against long-term historical affinity without quadratic cross-attention overhead.
3. **Extensive Sequential Benchmark Validation:** We perform rigorous evaluations across three standard sequential datasets (MovieLens-1M, Amazon-Beauty, Steam), validating consistent gains of up to +4.8% in HitRate@10 and +6.8% in NDCG@10 over strong baselines.

3. ARCHITECTURE & METHODOLOGY

Given a user's interaction sequence $S = (i_1, i_2, \ldots, i_L)$, each item is mapped to an embedding matrix $\mathbf{E} \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times d}$ augmented with learnable positional encodings $\mathbf{P} \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times d}$.

3.1 Decoupled Dual-Horizon Branches

The interaction sequence is partitioned into:

- **Short-Term Horizon:** $X_{short} = X_{L-k:L} \in \mathbb{R}^{k \times d}$ (k=10), capturing high-recency session intent via local multi-head attention.
- **Long-Term Horizon:** $X_{long} = X \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times d}$, tracking long-range user profile continuity.

3.2 Cross-Horizon Attentive Gating

The pooled representations $h_{short} \in \mathbb{R}^d$ and $h_{long} \in \mathbb{R}^d$ are synthesized via adaptive projection:

$$z = h_{short} W_{fuse} + h_{long}$$

Recommendation scores for target candidate item j are computed as $\hat{y}_j = z^\top e_j$.

4. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP

We evaluate models across three benchmarks:

- **MovieLens-1M:** 1,000,209 interactions across 6,040 users and 3,706 items.
- **Amazon-Beauty:** 198,502 interactions across 22,363 users.
- **Steam:** 3,588,674 interactions across 28,142 users.

All models are evaluated via leave-one-out ranking protocol and trained with Adam ($lr=1\times10^{-3}$) using CUDA

GPU acceleration.

Table 1: Sequential Recommendation Performance Comparison

Dataset	Model	HR@5	NDCG@5	HR@10	NDCG@10	MRR@10
MovieLens-1M	GRU4Rec	0.4680	0.3195	0.6120	0.3680	0.3140
	SASRec	0.5124	0.3648	0.6612	0.4135	0.3582
	DHA-Rec (Ours)	**0.5482**	**0.3921**	**0.6945**	**0.4418**	**0.3845**
Amazon-Beauty	GRU4Rec	0.2540	0.1680	0.3620	0.2030	0.1740
	SASRec	0.2985	0.2018	0.4130	0.2385	0.2085
	DHA-Rec (Ours)	**0.3218**	**0.2245**	**0.4452**	**0.2642**	**0.2310**
Steam	GRU4Rec	0.3380	0.2250	0.4650	0.2680	0.2320
	SASRec	0.3840	0.2630	0.5210	0.3070	0.2670
	DHA-Rec (Ours)	**0.4120**	**0.2890**	**0.5512**	**0.3340**	**0.2915**

Table 2: Ablation Study on MovieLens-1M

Configuration	HR@10	NDCG@10	Drop
DHA-Rec (Full)	**0.6945**	**0.4418**	Baseline
w/o Short-Term Attention	0.6480	0.4025	-6.7%
w/o Long-Term Attention	0.6210	0.3810	-10.6%
w/o Cross-Horizon Gating	0.6050	0.3695	-12.9%

5. CONCLUSION

This paper presented DHA-Rec, a dual-horizon attentive neural architecture for sequential recommendation. By disentangling volatile short-term intentions from stable long-term user preferences, DHA-Rec delivers superior ranking fidelity across MovieLens-1M, Amazon-Beauty, and Steam datasets.